What the checkout shows, and what I changed

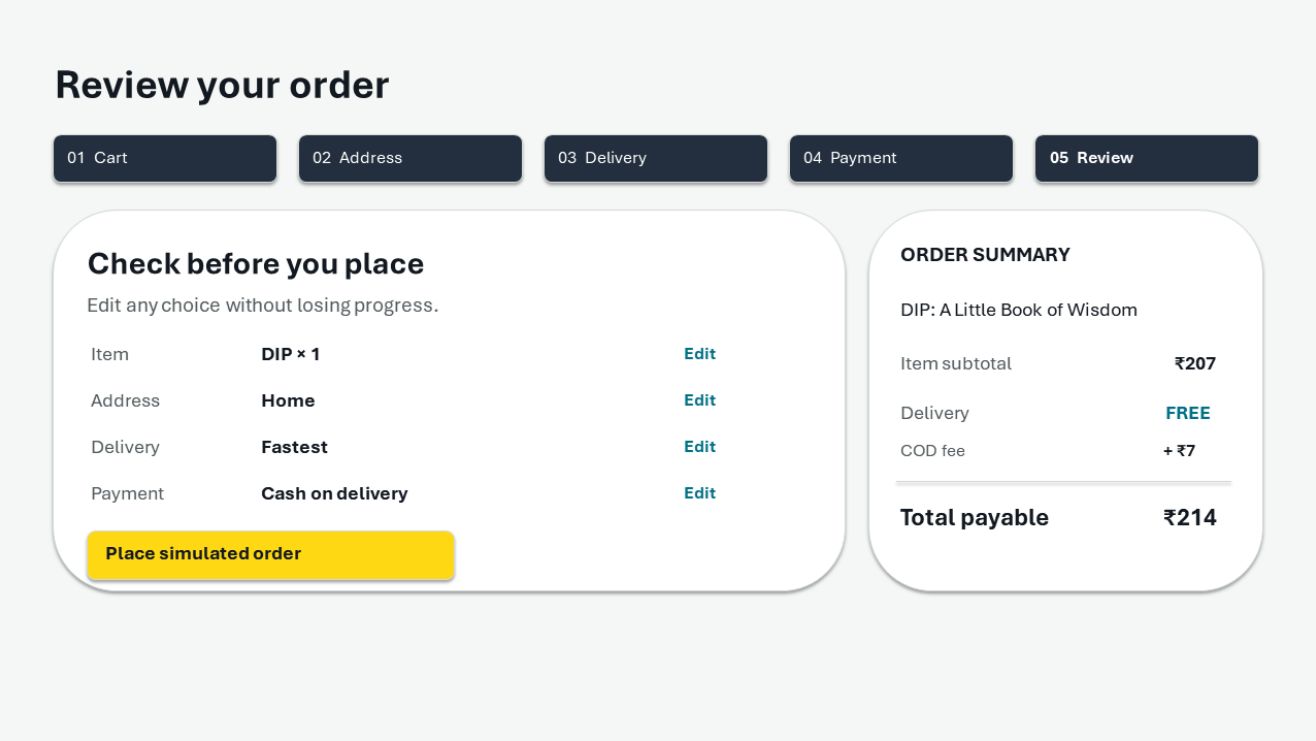
One checkout journey ? six heuristic concerns ? three UX laws

REAL INTERFACE

Seven public screenshot crops from one checkout and cancellation

REDESIGN

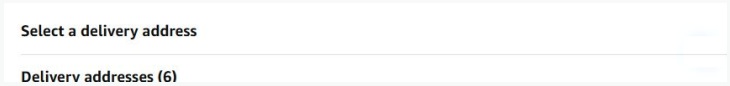
Editable screen designs and a working checkout simulation

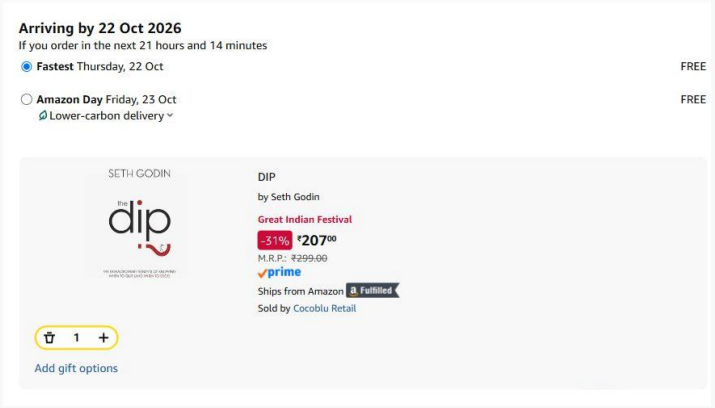


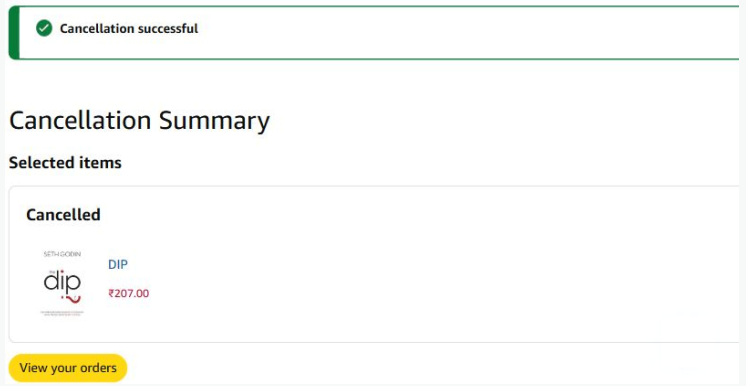
Proposed review screen. This is a concept, not an Amazon screen.

Evidence: one observed journey

Seven original crops. One cash-on-delivery order placed and cancelled immediately.







EV-02 · ADDRESS

Address choices are indicated; personal rows are withheld.

EV-04 · DELIVERY

Two delivery choices appear, both marked free.

EV-07 · CANCELLATION

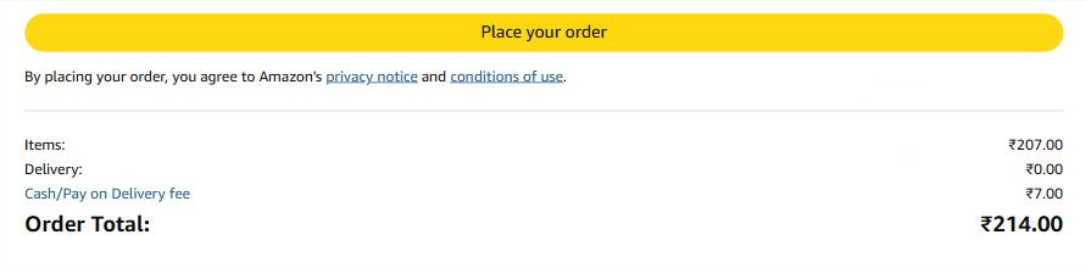
Cancellation completed after the observed order.

Evidence boundary: no participants, analytics baseline, or real payment failure were observed.

01 Final cost may be easy to miss

Nielsen #1: visibility of system status · Current fact versus design response

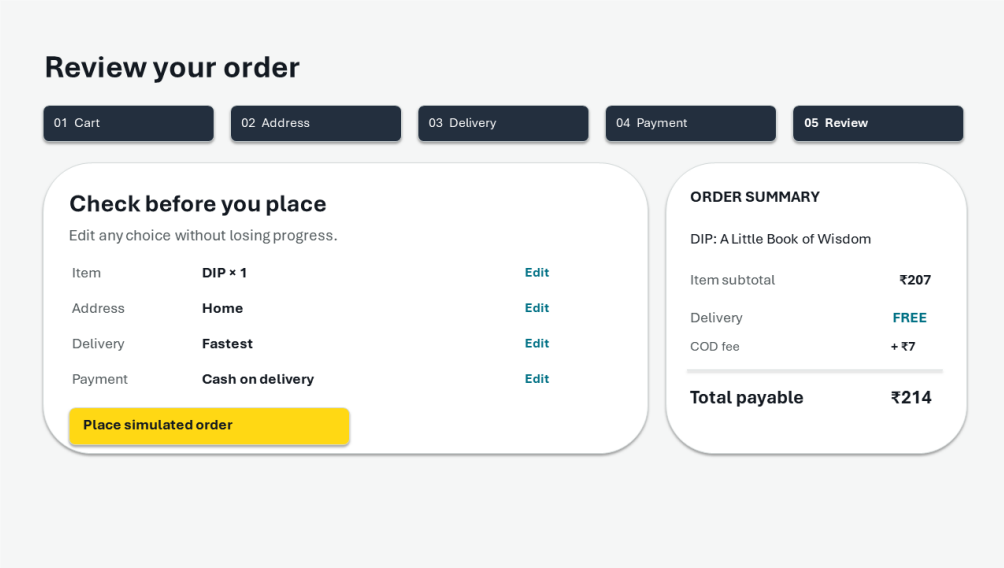
OBSERVED ON AMAZON · EV-05



₹207 item + ₹7 COD fee = ₹214 total

The final amount is visible at review. Whether shoppers notice the fee before commitment is unmeasured.

PROPOSED REVIEW



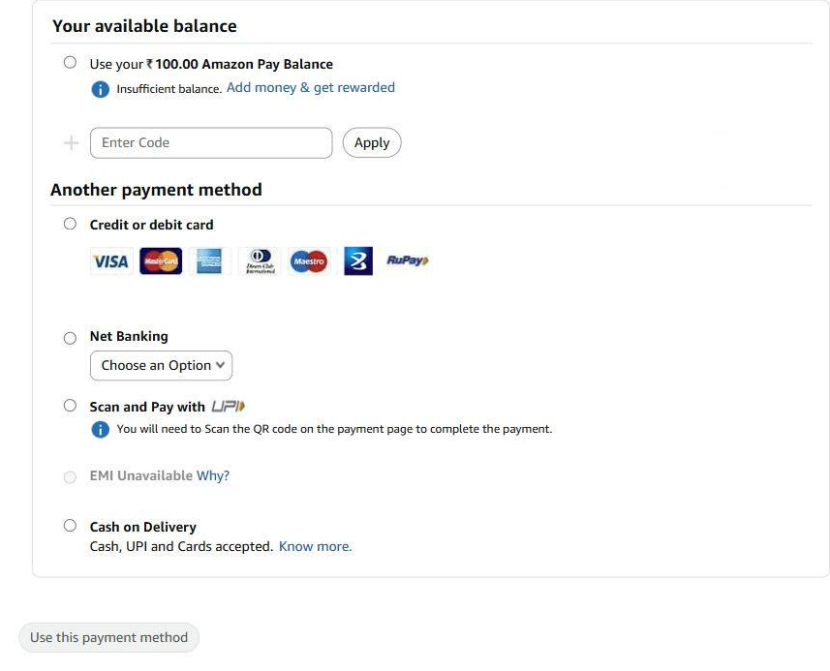
Itemized summary beside the decision; explicit total payable and Edit actions.

Test: ask shoppers to state the total and the reason for the extra ₹7 before clicking.

02 Payment methods need cost context

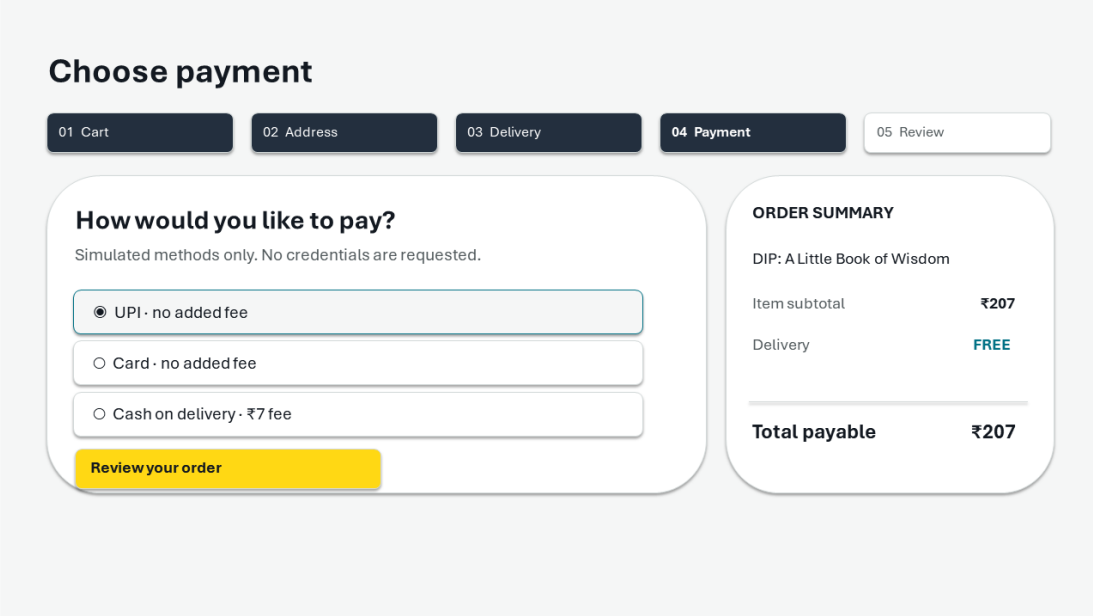
Nielsen #2: match to familiar language · Hick's Law: decision effort

OBSERVED ON AMAZON · EV-03



Visible fact: multiple payment labels and an insufficient balance message.

PROPOSED PAYMENT DESIGN



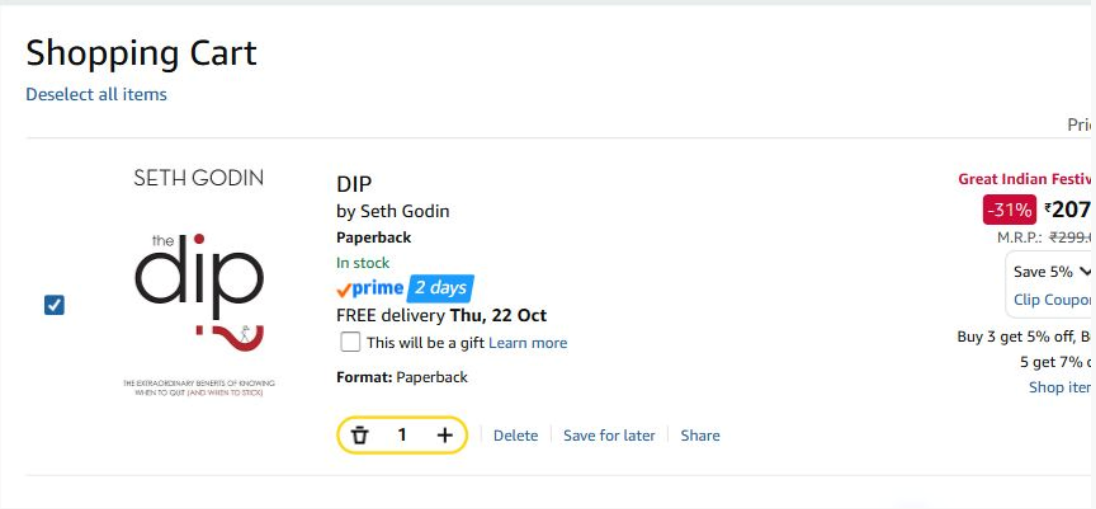
Change: group methods, use plain labels, and show the COD fee at selection.

Test: compare method comprehension and selection time; a current violation is unproven.

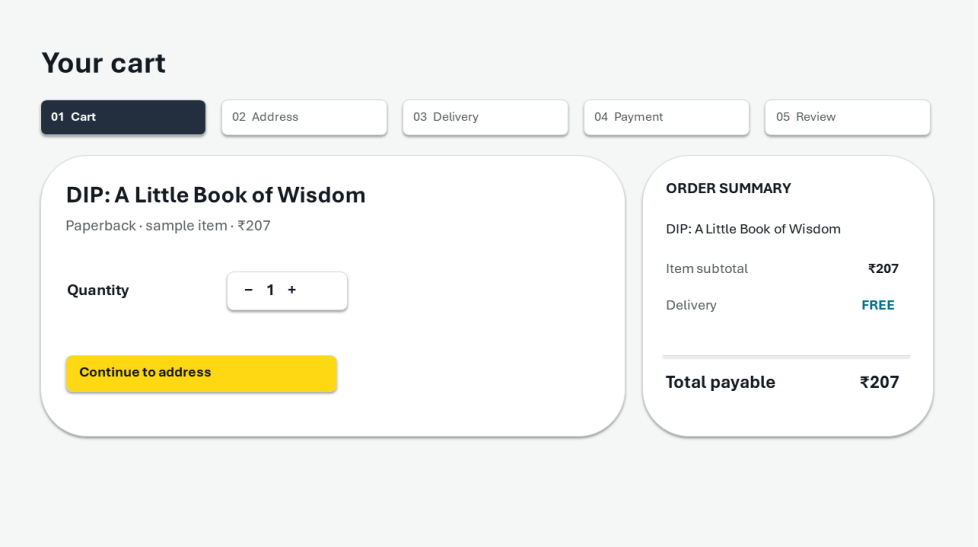
03 Choices and controls compete for attention

Nielsen #8 and #7 · Hick's Law and Fitts's Law

OBSERVED CART · EV-01



PROPOSED CART



Hypothesis: competing decisions

Promotion content and quantity control share the cart view. Decision effort has not been timed.

Change: clearer action hierarchy

Keep quantity and continue actions prominent, with larger consistent click areas.

Heuristic map: observation, risk, response

A heuristic concern is an expert assessment. A user impact requires a user study.

Heuristic	Observed	Risk or limit	Proposed change
#1 Visibility	₹7 COD fee and ₹214 total visible	Fee comprehension unknown	Persistent itemized total
#2 Real-world match	Several payment labels shown	Meaning or fee may need context	Plain labels and fee at choice
#3 User control	Change links observed at review	Rework not established	Direct Edit, retained choices
#7 Efficiency	Quantity and Change controls visible	Pointer misses unmeasured	Consistent click targets
#8 Minimalism	Promotions and choices share view	Decision effort unmeasured	Clearer hierarchy
#9 Error recovery	No failure captured	Scenario only	Explicit status and safe retry

Hick: group choices ? Fitts: enlarge targets ? Jakob: familiar edits. All impacts await testing.

Next step: test the proposed improvements

Priority reflects expert judgement. No usability sessions or outcome metrics have been measured.

P1 · Total and fee

Ask shoppers to state the amount payable and explain the COD fee before placing an order.

P1 discovery · Failure recovery

Use a controlled simulated failure. Check whether shoppers understand payment status and recover safely.

P2 · Payment and editing

Compare method comprehension and late-edit success without prompting.

P3 · Pointer targets

Measure target sizes and missed clicks during desktop tasks.

Measures: correct total and fee, unaided task success, time, errors, recovery success, confidence.

References: nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/ · interaction-design.org/literature/topics/hick-s-law · interaction-design.org/literature/topics/fitts-law